Name: _____ **Period:** _____ **Date:** _____

Topic 5.4B Guided Notes: Anxiety, OCD, Dissociative, and Trauma Disorders

Unit 5: Mental and Physical Health | AP Psychology

Directions: Read through the topic overview page below and fill in each blank as you go. Use the tables and activities to check your understanding, then head to the quiz link at the end to test yourself.

Source page: appsychreviewhub.com/overviews/topic5.4

Word Bank

Anxiety Disorders	*Panic Disorder*	*Panic Attacks*
Compulsions	*Agoraphobia*	*Hoarding Disorder*
Ataque de Nervios	*Specific Phobia*	*Arachnophobia*
Taijin Kyofusho	*Obsessions*	*Generalized Anxiety Disorder (GAD)*
Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD)	*Acrophobia*	*Social Anxiety Disorder*

This is guide 2 of 3 for Topic 5.4 (Sections 5–8). Section numbers match the study guide page.

5. Anxiety Disorders

_____ constitute a broad group of psychological disorders characterized by excessive, persistent fear, anxiety, or avoidance behaviors that actively interfere with daily functioning. Possible causes include learned associations between stimuli (classical conditioning), maladaptive cognitive thinking patterns, or physiological over-arousal of the autonomic nervous system.

- _____: Characterized by an intense, irrational fear of, and subsequent avoidance of, a specific object or situation that leads to extreme distress. Common subtypes include _____ (an intense and irrational fear of heights) and _____ (an intense and irrational fear of spiders).
- _____: A distinct anxiety disorder characterized by an intense fear of situations where escape might be difficult or help unavailable if panic symptoms strike. This frequently leads to severe avoidance of open places, enclosed spaces (such as shops or theaters), crowded venues, public transportation, standing in long lines, or being outside of the home entirely alone.
- _____: Involves the recurring experience of unexpected _____. Each one is a sudden, unanticipated episode of intense fear or discomfort that peaks within minutes and triggers overwhelming physical and cognitive symptoms like a racing heartbeat, chest pain, dizziness, and a terrifying fear of losing control.
- _____ (a culture-bound form of panic): A culture-bound syndrome experienced mainly by people of Caribbean or Iberian descent. It presents as an episode of intense emotional distress featuring shouting, uncontrollable crying, trembling, heat sensations, and occasionally aggression or dissociation directly following a severe stressful event.

- _____: Characterized by an intense fear or anxiety in social or performance situations due to deep-seated concerns about being judged, embarrassed, rejected, or scrutinized by others.
- _____ (a culture-bound form of social anxiety): A culture-bound anxiety syndrome experienced mainly in Japanese culture. Unlike Western social anxiety, which focuses on fear of personal embarrassment, individuals with this syndrome harbor an intense fear of offending, displeasing, or embarrassing others through their physical appearance, body odor, facial expressions, or movements.
- _____: An anxiety disorder in which a person experiences prolonged, chronic, and nonspecific anxiety or worry about a wide array of everyday events or activities, leaving them continuously tense, apprehensive, and in a state of constant autonomic nervous system arousal.

Apply It: Which Anxiety Disorder?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A hiker is so terrified of heights that he refuses to climb even one step of an open lookout-tower staircase and avoids all tall buildings.	
2	A woman screams, refuses to enter her garage, and avoids it for weeks after seeing a harmless spider there.	
3	A boy has an intense, irrational fear of balloons and goes to extreme lengths to avoid birthday parties.	
4	A man keeps having sudden, unexpected surges of terror with a pounding heart, and he constantly worries about when the next one will strike.	
5	While sitting quietly at her desk, a student suddenly feels intense terror, chest pain, and dizziness that peak within ten minutes and then fade.	
6	After a family tragedy, a woman of Caribbean descent shouts, cries uncontrollably, trembles, and feels a wave of heat.	

6. Obsessive-Compulsive and Related Disorders

This category encompasses disorders where individuals are driven by intrusive cognitive events and repetitive, rigid behavioral sequences. Possible causes are multi-causal: many cases are driven by maladaptive reinforcement pathways, where performing a rigid routine temporarily reduces severe internal psychological distress, while others point to biological and genetic vulnerabilities or underlying maladaptive thinking patterns.

- _____: Persistent, intrusive, recurrent, and unwanted thoughts, urges, or mental images that cause significant anxiety or distress to the individual. These thoughts feel uncontrollable and interrupt typical cognitive processing.
- _____: Repetitive behaviors (such as hand washing or checking locks) or mental acts (such as counting or repeating words silently) performed in a rigid response to an obsession, designed explicitly to reduce anxiety or prevent a dreaded event from occurring.
- _____: A condition characterized by the cyclical presence of these time-consuming obsessions and compulsions, which severely disrupt daily routines and impair normal functioning.

- _____: A disorder characterized by persistent difficulty discarding or parting with possessions, regardless of their actual material value. This behavior results in an excessive accumulation of clutter that compromises living spaces, making them unsafe or unusable for daily living.

Apply It: Which Obsessive-Compulsive Concept?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A student cannot stop having unwanted, intrusive thoughts that she will accidentally hurt someone, and the thoughts cause her intense anxiety.	
2	A man must check that his front door is locked exactly seven times before leaving, to calm his fear that burglars will break in.	
3	A woman spends hours each day trapped in a cycle of distressing intrusive thoughts and rigid rituals meant to relieve them, and it has cost her her job.	
4	A man keeps every free sample, torn jacket, and broken gadget he has ever owned and becomes distressed at the idea of discarding any of it; his kitchen is now unusable.	

📺 *Video Notes: "OCD and Anxiety Disorders" (Crash Course Psychology #29)*

Answer each question below in your own words. The video doesn't cover agoraphobia by name, hoarding, or the culture-bound syndromes, but it explains causes (learning and biology) that go beyond the page.

1. How does the video say anxiety disorders are defined, and how are they different from ordinary fear?

2. How does the video describe OCD, and what myths does it bust?

3. How does the video describe generalized anxiety disorder and panic disorder?

4. How does the video describe phobias, avoidance, and social anxiety?

5. What two perspectives does the video give on the causes of anxiety, and what main points does it make about each?

Word Bank

Dissociative Amnesia	*Posttraumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD)*	*Dissociative Disorders*
Hypervigilance	*Flashbacks*	*Dissociative Identity Disorder (DID)*
Fugue		

7. Dissociative Disorders

_____ are a group of psychological disorders characterized by sudden disruptions, breakdowns, or discontinuities in memory, identity, consciousness, emotion, perception of reality, body representation, or motor control. Psychological theories view this pattern as an extreme defense mechanism, almost always triggered by the experience of severe, overwhelming trauma or profound developmental stress.

- _____: A condition characterized by an inability to recall important personal information, typically related to traumatic or highly stressful events, that goes far beyond ordinary forgetting.
- _____ (a rare form of dissociative amnesia): A rare specifier involving sudden, unexpected travel away from one's home or usual environment, accompanied by complete amnesia for one's identity or past, sometimes leading to the assumption of an entirely new life and identity.
- _____: A complex condition characterized by the clear presence of two or more distinct identity states or personalities that recurrently take control of a person's behavior, accompanied by significant gaps in memory for everyday events and personal history across those identities.

Apply It: Which Dissociative Concept?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	A clinician describes a group of disorders marked by sudden breaks in memory, identity, or awareness, often linked to overwhelming trauma.	
2	After surviving a violent robbery, a man cannot remember anything about the event or the hours around it, even though he had no head injury, and his memory loss goes far beyond ordinary forgetting.	
3	A woman suddenly leaves home without telling anyone, travels to another state, takes a new name, and has no memory of who she was.	
4	A man's behavior is at times controlled by two clearly different identities with separate names and mannerisms, and he has gaps in his memory for events that happened while the other identity was in control.	

📺 *Video Notes (Part 2): "Schizophrenia and Dissociative Disorders" (Crash Course Psychology #32)*

Return to the same video you used in Guide 5.4A, this time from about 8:05 to the end, which covers dissociative disorders. Answer each question below in your own words.

1. How does the video describe dissociative disorders in general?

2. What does the video say about Dissociative Identity Disorder and the Sybil case?

3. According to the video, how well do we understand DID, and what evidence and explanations does it mention?

8. Trauma and Stressor-Related Disorders

This class of disorders requires explicit exposure to a traumatic, catastrophic, or profoundly stressful event as a diagnostic baseline, leading to subsequent psychological distress and functional impairment.

- _____: A disorder that develops after exposure to a traumatic event (such as warfare, physical assault, or natural disasters). It is characterized by persistent intrusive symptoms, including vivid _____ (intrusive experiences where a person feels as though they are actively reliving the trauma), avoidance of reminders, and a state of chronic _____—heightened alertness and constant, exhausting scanning of the environment for potential threats. Additional symptoms may include insomnia, emotional detachment from others, and unexpected irritability or hostility.

Apply It: Which Trauma-Related Concept?

Using the word bank above, identify which concept best matches each scenario.

#	Scenario	Concept
1	Months after a serious house fire, a woman has nightmares, avoids anything that reminds her of it, sleeps poorly, and has become irritable with everyone.	
2	While walking past a construction site, a firefighter suddenly feels as though he is back in a burning building, reliving the event in vivid detail.	
3	A survivor of a violent assault keeps checking over her shoulder, startles at every footstep, and cannot relax even in her locked apartment.	

📺 *Video Notes: "Trauma and Addiction" (Crash Course Psychology #31)*

Your page notes that addiction is not a specific disorder required for the AP exam, so you can skip the addiction parts of this video (about 3:27 to 4:02 and 7:09 to the end). Watch the rest, then answer each question below in your own words.

1. How does the video define PTSD, and what four symptom clusters does it describe?

2. According to the video, what causes PTSD and what raises the risk?

3. How does the video connect PTSD to the brain?

4. What does the video say about positive change after trauma?

Don't Trip Up! (Common Misconceptions)

⚠️ Schizophrenia vs. DID: Popular media often confuses these two. Schizophrenia (covered in Guide 5.4A) is a psychotic spectrum disorder featuring a split from reality (hallucinations, word salad, dopamine imbalances). _____ is a dissociative disorder featuring a fracturing of identity into multiple separate states due to trauma. They are structurally completely different conditions!

Quick Check: Review Questions

Circle the best answer for each question below.

1. A woman refuses to ride the subway, avoids grocery stores, and will not stand in long lines anywhere, all because she fears that if a panic attack strikes, she would be unable to escape or get help in these specific situations. This anxiety disorder is called:

- **A.** Agoraphobia
- **B.** Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder
- **C.** Specific Phobia
- **D.** Social Anxiety Disorder

2. A man consistently avoids school presentations and job interviews due to an intense, deep-seated fear of being judged, embarrassed, or scrutinized negatively by the people observing him. This anxiety disorder is called:

- **A.** Specific Phobia
- **B.** Generalized Anxiety Disorder
- **C.** Social Anxiety Disorder
- **D.** Agoraphobia

3. A man in Japanese culture experiences an intense fear that his own body odor, facial expressions, or physical appearance might offend, displease, or embarrass the people around him, which is distinctly different from a typical Western fear of personal embarrassment. This culture-bound anxiety syndrome is called:

- **A.** Dissociative Fugue
- **B.** Taijin Kyofusho
- **C.** Agoraphobia
- **D.** Ataque de Nervios

4. A woman experiences chronic, excessive worry about her finances, her health, her job performance, and her family's safety nearly every single day, leaving her constantly tense and on edge even when there is no specific, identifiable threat present. This anxiety disorder is called:

- **A.** Panic Disorder
- **B.** Generalized Anxiety Disorder (GAD)
- **C.** Specific Phobia
- **D.** Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder

5. Driven by his distressing intrusive thoughts about germs, a man washes his hands exactly 20 times in a row every single time he touches a doorknob, specifically to reduce his anxiety and prevent contamination. This repetitive, anxiety-reducing behavior is called a:

- **A.** Compulsion
- **B.** Flashback
- **C.** Obsession
- **D.** Delusion

6. A woman's home has become so filled with newspapers, boxes, and various items she refuses to throw away, regardless of their actual value, that several rooms are now completely unusable and unsafe to walk through. This disorder is called:

- **A.** Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder
- **B.** Persistent Depressive Disorder
- **C.** Hoarding Disorder
- **D.** Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder

7. A woman diagnosed after years of severe childhood trauma exhibits two or more clearly distinct identity states that recurrently take control of her behavior, accompanied by significant gaps in her memory for everyday events across those different identities. This disorder is called:

- **A.** Dissociative Amnesia
- **B.** Schizophrenia
- **C.** Borderline Personality Disorder
- **D.** Dissociative Identity Disorder (DID)

8. A war veteran with PTSD constantly and exhaustively scans every room he enters for potential exits and threats, feeling perpetually on edge and unable to relax even in objectively safe environments like his own living room. This state of heightened alertness is called:

- **A.** A Flashback
- **B.** Dissociative Amnesia
- **C.** Mania
- **D.** Hypervigilance

✅ Check Your Progress

Done with your notes? Head over to the Quiz to test what you've learned:
https://appsychreviewhub.com/quiz

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